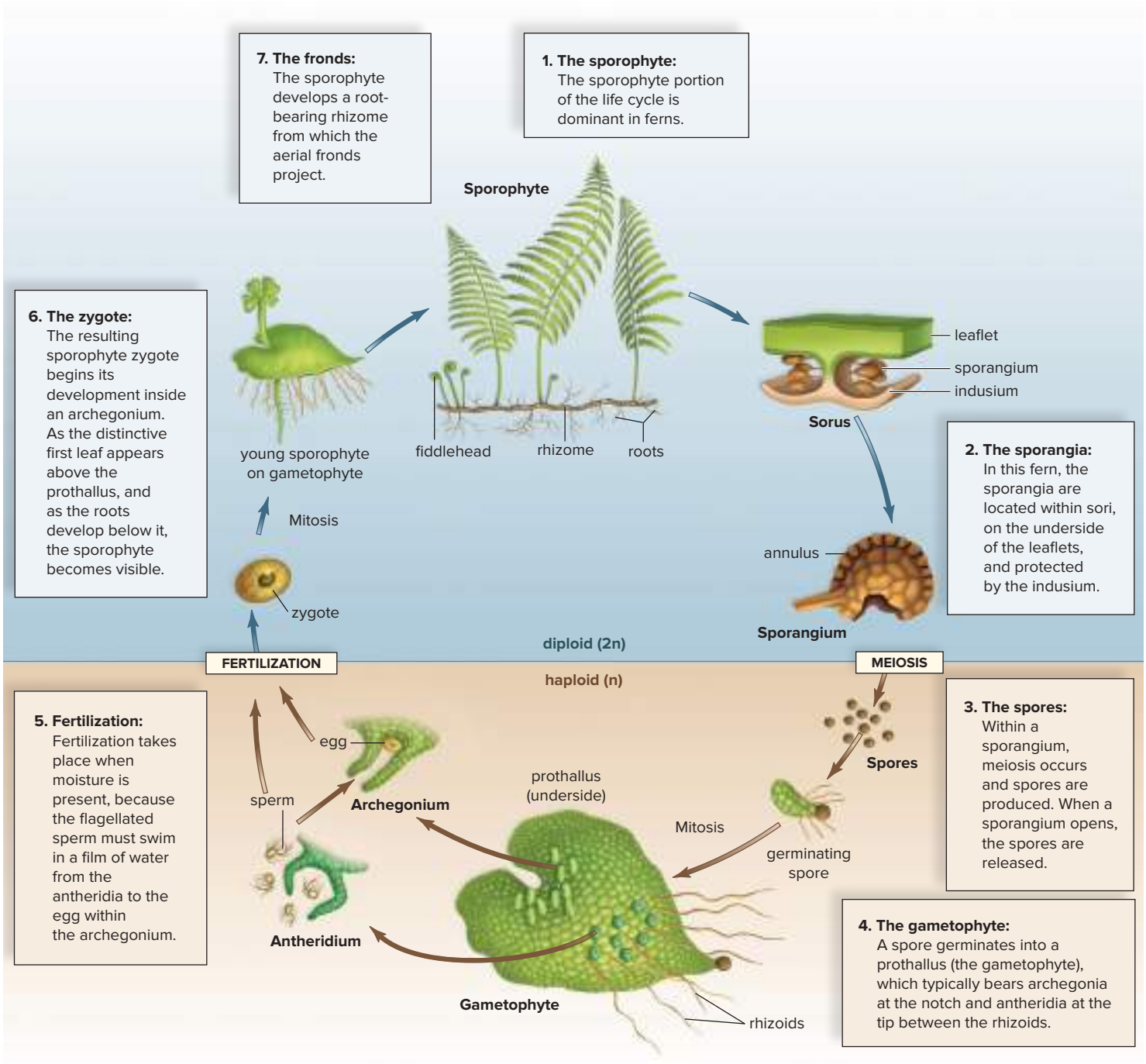


Figure 23.16 Fern life cycle. Stages of a typical fern life cycle.

growth) as a special treat. Ferns also have medicinal value; many Native Americans use them as an astringent during childbirth to stop bleeding, and the maidenhair fern is the source of a cold medicine.

Check Your Progress 23.4

1. Compare the life cycle of a fern to that of a moss.
2. Describe the structures found on a fern megaphyll.
3. Explain the sequence of events in the haploid portion of the fern life cycle.

23.5 Evolution of Seed Plants: Full Adaptation to Land

Learning Outcomes

Upon completion of this section, you should be able to

1. Compare and contrast the differences between seed and seedless plants.
2. Describe different groups of gymnosperms.
3. Identify the key components of the gymnosperm and angiosperm life cycles.

ISTUDY